are combined with acts of harassment and arm-twisting and a howl goes up that the civilian population is being punished for the acts that have been committed by a handful of terrorists.'

As a result of the Nelliady attack, it was decided that patrolling in Jaffna district was to be undertaken jointly by the police and the military. A statement issued by the Sri Lankan security forces on 25 July said that an all-out offensive to wipe out terrorism in the north would be mounted and top priority would be given to flushing out terrorists in Jaffna.

A report dated 11 August 1982 said: 'Parcels of explosives have been found in railway wagons and carriages—some of these parcel bombs have been addressed to Ministers in the government, such as the Minister of Home Affairs and Minister of Posts and Telegraphs, as well as top police officers.'

On 27 August, Jayewardene sought a mandate from the people through a presidential election. Tamil leaders, however, were wary of the president's move. Speaking in Trincomalee on 30 August, TULF president M. Sivasitham-param said: 'Tamils have no interest in the Presidential election because it will be a poll to elect a person who will rule Sinhala people in a Sinhala country. The Tamils have no interest in the election of a Sinhala ruler.' He defended TULF's dialogue with the government and said that Tamils were being harassed and had no alternative but to complain to the president of the country.

'Three million people were massacred during the independence struggle in Bangladesh.

A similar sacrifice could not be made here because then there would be no Tamils left to form Eelam. It is therefore the desire of the TULF to ensure the safety of Tamils while fighting for